Haverford College ASTR101 - Spring 2020, Prof. Karen Masters

Observing at Home Log.
Name: Date/Time:

Use this to make notes on the objects you observe during an Observing Session. Make sure to note the date and time of your observations.

This assumes you have a smart phone onto which you can download the free "Loss of the Night" ap: https://apps.apple.com/us/app/loss-of-the-night/id928440562 or https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.cosalux.welovestars&hl=en_US. You can use this to help you find the below constellations. Other free phone aps are available, and are fine to use if you have one.

The Big Dipper and North

Sketch the Big Dipper (part of "Ursa Major" and the pole star (polaris) here. Include the horizon, and indicate the (approx) angle the pole star is above the horizon. Use this to estimate the latitude of your observing location.

Pleiades

You can use the three stars in the belt of Orion to point to the Pleiades cluster. Try to find it. Now how many stars can you see in the pleiades with the unaided eye. Reflect on any challenges you had finding it.

Constellation
Make a sketch of one constellation (not the Big Dipper or Pleiades asterisms) you can identify (e.g. Orion, Cassiopeia may be easy choices). Comment on why you picked this one. Was it easy or difficult to identify?

Moon - if the moon is visible note its phase. If it is not visible comment why (e.g. trees, clouds, opacity of the Earth…)

Sky Brightness Measurement
Now use the Loss of the Sky ap to make an submit a measurement of sky brightness at your location. Reflect on the experience here - was it easy, tricky. Would you do it again?